FEATURES EDITOR & CONTENT STRATEGIST

Laras Kusumawardhani

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Summary

I edit long-form stories about cities, food and the people who keep them going, and I build the plans that bring those stories to readers. In ten years I have moved from a regional newsroom to leading the features desk of a magazine read by 2.3 million people a month, in print, on the web and as a podcast.

Experience

Majalah Lembayung — Yogyakarta
Features Editor & Content Strategist — Feb 2022 – Present

- Lead a desk of six writers and two photographers; commission and edit 10 long-form features a month.
- Rebuilt the editorial calendar around reader data; average reading time rose from 2:40 to 6:15 minutes.
- Created and host Ruang Tunggu, a weekly podcast on public services with 45,000 listeners a month.
- Launched a paid weekly newsletter that reached 18,000 subscribers in its first year.

Kanal Kota — Jakarta
Senior Writer — Jun 2018 – Jan 2022

- Wrote 60+ features on urban life and public services; three were cited in city council hearings.
- Set up the site's first SEO and headline-testing guide, doubling search traffic to features in a year.

Warta Jogja — Yogyakarta
Reporter — Aug 2015 – May 2018

- Covered culture, education and city hall for a daily paper; filed four stories a week.

Selected Features

Kota yang Tenggelam Pelan-pelan — Sep 2024
Majalah Lembayung
Land subsidence on the north coast of Java.

Dapur Terakhir di Gang Sayidan — Mar 2023
Majalah Lembayung
A year inside a 70-year-old family warung.

Education

Universitas Gadjah Mada
Journalism
Bachelor of Communication Science • GPA 3.64
Yogyakarta • 2011 – 2015

Skills

Editorial
Editing, Commissioning, Fact-checking

Strategy
Content calendars, SEO, Google Analytics

Audio
Scripting, Hindenburg, Audition

Awards

Best Long-Form Feature — 2024
Anugerah Pena Nusantara

Public Service Reporting, finalist — 2020
Forum Pewarta Kota